

New Ground: The Second Attempt

新的起点：第二次尝试

Theme: 大学生活与个人成长 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The second attempt began with a test the group had not designed. A member of the college council, a guy named Wen, handed them a list of five buildings and said that a student leader should walk the route with his eyes closed. He was joking; nobody laughed. Beneath the joke lay a fair demand: the map had to work for someone who had never seen the campus. Hence the rule that Lin, usually the fastest walker, would go first, while the president of the council waited at the gate.

Initially the walk went well. Then he lost track of the alley behind the sports hall, where a showy artificial sign pointed nowhere. Both of them stood there, and her patience narrowed. "Normally a map is a promise," she said. "This one is a luxury." Elsewhere, water from the swimming pool had accumulated along the avenue, and the ugly cloth banner above the door was too wet to read. A small crowd began to gather behind them, which was worse than the rain.

They resolved to test the wording instead of the route. On behalf of the volunteers, Maya rewrote each line and duly recorded every hesitation. "Preferable" became "better"; "atop the hill" became "at the top of the hill". Gradually the sentences grew shorter, their eyesight of the real problem sharpened, and the emergence of a telling detail came on the fourth page: nobody had described the door from the outside. "We should often read our own report as a stranger would," she said.

The practicality of the project troubled Lin. To cultivate trust, he thought, you must first sow patience and then reap attention. A blouse soaked by rain, a cap left idly on a bench, and a troublesome locked gate all told the same story: the map was accurate and unusable. Ironically, the second walk missed the gate narrowly, and the narrowest point of the route was the one the designer had photographed most carefully. A major question had been answered, and it had produced a worse answer than doubt.

The reunification of the two maps took three evenings. It was no luxurious achievement and nobody wanted to celebrate it, but it was an advancement: the group could develop one gate at a time and conquer it in a single pass. The number of wrong turns had fallen, though not far. The smell near the canteen began to sicken Lin, and the queue continued to grow in the rain. "We have not overcome the city," Maya said. "We have only stopped lying about it."

中文翻译

第二次尝试从一场不是他们自己设计的测试开始。学院委员会的一位成员，一个叫文的家伙，递给他们一张写着五栋楼的清单，说学生领袖应该闭着眼睛走完这条路线。他是在开玩笑；没人笑。玩笑底下是一个合理的要求：这张地图必须对一个从未见过校园的人也有用。于是有了这条规则：通常是走得最快的林伟先走，而委员会主席在门口等着。

起初这段路走得很顺。随后他弄不清体育馆后面那条小巷的编号，那里一块艳丽的人造指示牌指向空处。两人站在那里，她的耐心变窄了。“通常地图是一个承诺，”她说，“而这个是奢侈品。”别处，游泳池的水顺着大道积了起来，门上方那块难看的布横幅湿得看不清。一小群人开始在他们身后聚集，这比下雨更糟。

他们决定测试措辞，而不是路线。曼雅代表志愿者重写了每一行并按时记录了每一次犹豫。“更可取”改成“更好”；“在山顶之上”改成“在山顶”。句子渐渐变短，他们对真正问题的眼力也变锐利了，第四页上浮现出一个说明问题的细节：没有人从外面描述过那扇门。“我们应该常常像陌生人那样读自己的报告，”她说。

项目的实用性让林伟不安。他想到，要培养信任，必须先播下耐心，才能收获关注。一件被雨浸透的上衣、一顶被闲闲留在长椅上的帽子、一道麻烦的锁门，都在讲同一个故事：这张地图准确却无法使用。讽刺的是，整条路线中最窄的那一点，正是设计者拍得最仔细的地方。一个重要问题被回答了，而它给出的答案比怀疑更糟。

两张地图的重新统一花了三个晚上。这不是什么豪华的成就，也没人想庆祝，但它确实是一次进步：小组可以一次只开发一道门，并在一趟之内把它攻克。走错路的次数减少了，虽然减少得不多。食堂附近的气味开始让林伟恶心，队伍在雨里继续变长。“我们并没有战胜这座城市，”曼雅说，“我们只是不再对它说谎。”

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
he hi: POS: pron	pron. 他; n. 男孩, 男人, 雄性动物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the 5th letter of the Hebrew alphabet
both bəʊθ POS: a	a. 两者的; adv. 两者都; pron. 两者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. (used with count nouns) two considered together; the two
usually ˈjuːʒuəli POS: adv	adv. 通常, 大抵 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r under normal conditions
instead in'sted POS: adv	adv. 作为替代, 反而 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r in place of, or as an alternative to; r on the contrary; rather (or instead), he wrote her a letter"
normally ˈnɔːməli POS: adv	adv. 正规地, 合规则, 正常地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. under normal conditions
elsewhere ˈelʃweə POS: adv	adv. 在别处 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in or to another place
beneath bi'ni:θ POS: prep	prep. 在...下方; adv. 在...下方 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r in or to a place that is lower
hence hens POS: adv	adv. 因此, 从此 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. from this place; r. from this time
celebrate ˈselibreit POS: v	v. 庆祝, 祝贺, 举行 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. have a celebration
resolve ri'zɒlv POS: vi	vi. 决定, 分解, 决心; vt. 使分解, 解析, 解决, 消除, 决心; n. 决定之事, 决心, 坚决 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make clearly visible; v. find the solution
initially i'niʃəli POS: adv	adv. 最初, 开头 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. at the beginning
gradually ˈgrædʒuəli POS: adv	adv. 逐渐地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in a gradual manner
overcome ˌəuve'kʌm POS: vt	vt. 战胜, 克服, 胜过; vi. 得胜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. get on top of; deal with successfully
nowhere ˈnəʊhweə POS: adv	adv. 无处, 到处都无 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an insignificant place; r. not anywhere; in or at or to no place
ugly ˈʌgli POS: a	a. 丑陋的, 邪恶的, 险恶的, 不祥的; n. 丑陋的人(或物) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. displeasing to the senses
cloth klo:θ. kloθ POS: n	n. 布料, 织品, 布; [建] 布 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n artifact made by weaving or felting or knitting or crocheting natural or synthetic fibers
artificial ˌɑːti'fiʃəl POS: a	a. 人造的, 假的, 非原地产的; [医] 人工的, 人造的, 伟牟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. contrived by art rather than nature; s. artificially formal; s. not arising from natural growth or character...
avenue ˈævenju: POS: n	n. 大街, 途径, 林荫路 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a line of approach; n. a wide street or thoroughfare
swimming ˈswimiŋ POS: n	n. 游泳, 眩晕 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of swimming
alley ˈæli POS: n	n. 小路, 巷 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a narrow street with walls on both sides
behalf bi'ha:f POS: n	n. 利益, 方面 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. as the agent of or on someone's part (usually expressed as "on behalf of" rather than "in behalf of"); ; n. ...
atop ə'tɒp POS: adv	adv. 在顶上; prep. 在...的顶上 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. on, to, or at the top
ironically phonetic unavailable POS: adv	adv. 冷嘲地, 挖苦地, 讽刺地, 令人啼笑皆非地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. contrary to plan or expectation; r. in an ironic manner
accumulate ə'kju:mjuleit POS: v	v. 积聚, 堆积 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. collect or gather

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
emergence i'mə:dʒəns POS: n	n. 出现, 浮现, 发生 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the gradual beginning or coming forth; n. the becoming visible; n. the act of emerging
luxury 'lʌkʃəri POS: n	n. 奢侈, 豪华; a. 奢侈的, 豪华的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that is an indulgence rather than a necessity; n. wealth as evidenced by sumptuous living
duly 'dju:li POS: adv	adv. 恰当地, 充分地, 适当地, 及时地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r at the proper time
cultivate 'kʌltiveɪt POS: vt	vt. 培养, 耕作 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. foster the growth of; v. prepare for crops
wording 'wɜ:diŋ POS: n	n. 用词, 措词 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the manner in which something is expressed in words
blouse blauz POS: n	n. 宽松的上衣 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a top worn by women
advancement əd'vɑ:nsmənt POS: n	n. 前进, 进步, 提升; [医] 徙前术 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. gradual improvement or growth or development
conquer 'kɒŋkə POS: vt	vt. 克服, 征服, 战胜; vi. 得胜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. overcome by conquest
narrowly 'næərəuli POS: adv	adv. 狭窄地, 严密地, 仔细地, 几乎不, 勉强地, 仅仅 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in a narrow manner; not allowing for exceptions
sow sau. səu POS: n	n. 母猪, 懒胖女人; vt. 播种, 散布, 使密布; vi. 播种 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an adult female hog; v. place (seeds) in or on the ground for future growth; v. introduce into an environment
preferable 'prefərəbl POS: a	a. 更可取的, 更好的, 更合意的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. more desirable than another
reap ri:p POS: vt	vt. 收割, 收获, 获得; vi. 收割, 得到报应 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. gather, as of natural products; v. get or derive
luxurious lʌg'zjuəriəs POS: a	a. 豪华的, 奢侈的, 放纵的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s displaying luxury and furnishing gratification to the senses; s rich and superior in quality
troublesome 'trʌblsəm POS: a	a. 麻烦的, 令人讨厌的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. difficult to deal with
telling 'teliŋ POS: a	a. 有效的, 显著的, 显露内心活动的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. informing by words
practicality ,prækti'kæliti POS: n	n. 实际性, 实用性, 实际事物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. concerned with actual use rather than theoretical possibilities
reunification ,ri:ju:nifi'keɪʃən,ri:ju:- POS: n	n. 使重新统一, 使重新团结 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the act of coming together again
idly 'aidli POS: adv	adv. 懒惰地, 空闲地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in an idle manner
eyesight 'aisait POS: n	n. 视力, 目力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. normal use of the faculty of vision
sicken 'siken POS: vt	vt. 患病, 使厌倦, 使恶心; vi. 生病, 作呕 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. get sick; v. upset and make nauseated; v. make sick or ill
showy 'ʃəui POS: a	a. 艳丽的, 炫耀的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. displaying brilliance and virtuosity